

Course milestone M11: Poster First Draft

HONR 46400 · Evidence-Driven Research

What to submit

One document, `lastname_m11.pdf`. Everything this milestone asks for goes inside it, as sections in the order below. One artifact travels beside it, because it cannot live inside a PDF:

Submit it on Brightspace, under **Assignments** then **M11**. Brightspace carries the deadline.

Where this document has a **What this course adds** section, that section is part of the milestone and is graded, whether or not the course schedule marks this milestone.

This milestone presents **Book Milestone 10: Your artifact, ready to publish or present** (revisit, version 2 - the peer-reviewed draft) of the course book, EDR|AI.

- `lastname_m11_poster.pdf` (poster draft at print spec): The draft must be built on the course template at full conference print dimensions and judged for legibility at print scale, so it cannot be folded into the letter-size `lastname_m11.pdf`. The traceability sweep and the ledger rows, which used to be separate PDFs, do fold in.

What this course adds

Your format for this version is a poster

The book lets you pick a venue format. Here the course picks it for you: this version of the artifact is your **first full poster draft** for the research conference. Build it on the course poster template, sized to the conference print spec.

Every block must be on the board, even where it is still rough: title and author, the question, the design and data, the result with its uncertainty, the boundary, and the AI-use disclosure. Rough is fine. Missing is not, because a reader cannot find the defect in a block you never drew.

Two rules are checked on the board itself:

1. Every number traces to the cell that produced it.
2. The uncertainty sits in the same eye-span as the claim it qualifies.

What to do

1. **Storyboard on paper first.** Sketch the six blocks in the order a visitor's eye travels them, and place the headline in a position you can name and defend. A board laid out inside the software takes the shape the software offers.
2. **Build the draft on the template**, at the print spec, then check it once at print scale rather than screen scale. Text that reads well on a laptop is often unreadable from two metres, and that is where your reader stands.
3. **Run the traceability sweep.** List every number printed on the board with the notebook and the cell that produced it. Copy each one from the run, not from your earlier prose, which was rounded. Anything you cannot locate in a minute goes on the list marked *blocking*.
4. **Run the reach check.** Paste your headline sentence and its interval, and ask AI for every word that reaches further than the interval licenses, with no rewriting. Then confirm or dismiss each flag against your own claim-evidence table.
5. **Run the Poster Critic** in GenAI Studio on the draft. Do not ask whether it looks good. Ask what a visitor would conclude from the board alone, without being told your claim. Record that reading; a reading is something you can act on, a compliment is not.
6. **Hand it in at the start of Wednesday's class**, and bring a printed or screen-shareable copy with you. The structured peer review runs in that same session, and the review round reads the board, not the file listing.

Steps 4 and 5 each get their own ledger row, with the verification method named.

What goes where

Your poster draft uploads as its own file, at full print size, because it cannot be judged at spec inside a letter-size page. Everything else goes in `lastname_m11.pdf`: the storyboard sketch, the traceability sweep, and this milestone's ledger rows.

How it is judged

Beyond the book milestone's own rubric, your draft is read for four things: whether the six blocks deliver question, result, and bound in a ninety-second read; whether every printed number is traced or openly named as blocking; whether the uncertainty and the boundary sentence sit on the reading path; and whether the board arrives complete enough, and early enough, for every reader from another active project to give you an actionable finding. A draft that misses the review round has nothing to revise from before the lock.

Milestone 10: Your artifact, ready to publish or present

Open the milestone workbook in Colab

This chapter closes Studio 10: Prepare to publish or present. Its lessons each ended at **It is your turn**; what you wrote there arrives here as working material, and this is where the pieces become one artifact you can defend.

What this milestone produces. A short venue contract and one artifact ready for publication or presentation that satisfies it - a paper or research note, a seminar or conference talk, a poster, or another venue's format - with a content map tracing every load-bearing claim and number, and a defense rehearsal record. This is not yet public release.

What you bring

You also carry forward the last milestone's artifact: **Milestone 9: Your bounded claims**. This one builds on it, and the chain assumes it is versioned and filed.

Check you are carrying each of these before you start. If one is missing, go back and work that lesson's **It is your turn** first; the practice below assumes it.

- Lesson 35: Difficult Questions and Uncertainty: your five hardest fair questions with defend-or-concede answers, and your uncertainty-and-limitations statement in ULN form.

These pieces are conditional. Bring each one when its condition is yours; when it is not, the lesson's own drill or a plain skip is the right call, and the milestone does not require the piece.

- Lesson 32: Research Posters: if your venue is a poster, or your format carries a quantitative figure: the draft with labeled values, uncertainty shown as the design licenses (interval or caveat), and a headline verbed to your boundary.
- Lesson 33: Poster Criticism: if your venue is a poster: the gallery-walk audit of your draft, hits ranked by how far the error travels, fixed once, and the lock call.
- Lesson 34: Research Pitches, Talks, and Seminars: if you will speak, whether a pitch, a seminar, or a conference talk: your 30-second and 3-minute spines, built boundary-first, tested aloud on an outsider, and expanded to the venue's length.

Your format decides one more input. For a paper or research note, bring your Milestone 9 note; for a seminar or talk, the pitch spine; for a poster, the visual pieces above; for another format, the nearest row's input plus your venue contract. Difficult Questions is everyone's.

Choosing your format

The goal of this studio is an artifact ready for publication or presentation: a manuscript a venue could receive, a talk a room could hear, a poster a conference could hang. Start with a **venue contract**: your written record of what the audience will receive and what the venue allows. Name the audience, the medium, the length or space limit, the required elements, the accessibility needs, the submission rule, and the question channel. One line each is enough. Example: a five-minute recorded talk, six slides, captions required, no live questions.

Every format carries the same research core: the bounded claim, the evidence that earns it, uncertainty and limitations, traceable numbers and citations, and whatever disclosure or permission information the audience needs. The format only decides where those pieces live. Choose the row that fits your venue, work the lessons it names, and when you borrow a technique from another row, name the technique rather than claiming the whole lesson transfers.

If your venue asks for	build it with	then test and rehearse
a paper or research note	your Studio 9 note, developed to the venue contract: sections, length, references, and the figure rules for any figure	the audit on the manuscript; Difficult Questions in writing
a seminar or conference talk	Research Pitches' spine, expanded section by section to the venue's length; slides follow the poster lesson's figure rules	the audit on the deck; Difficult Questions, spoken
a short pitch	Research Pitches	Difficult Questions, spoken
a poster	Research Posters	Poster Criticism, then Difficult Questions
another format	the venue contract plus the nearest row, naming what transfers	Difficult Questions, in the venue's own mode

The poster lessons are this book's fully worked visual example: one surface, no narrator, every number exposed. The paper route runs on your Studio 9 note; the seminar route runs on the pitches lesson's spine. Difficult Questions is for everyone. If your venue has no live questions, the rehearsal still happens: have a peer or an AI reviewer send you hard questions in writing, and record defend, concede, or do-not-know for each.

The practice

1. Write your venue contract using the guide above, then say what your claim must lose to fit that format.
2. Write a transformation memo from your Studio 9 note: what expands, what compresses, what moves, what becomes visual, and what becomes spoken.
3. Build a content map before you build the artifact: where the claim, the evidence, the boundary, the uncertainty, and the disclosure will each live.
4. Build the artifact to its venue contract, keeping every load-bearing number, figure, and citation traceable to the claim-evidence table.
5. Test it in its actual mode: scan the poster at gallery distance, time the talk aloud, advance the deck without narrating, or hand the manuscript to a cold reader.
6. Rehearse the defense against the three hardest questions you can construct, and record which you could not answer; those are your next studio's agenda.

A version, not a pass

Your milestone artifact is a dated, numbered **version** with the reason for the version attached. When later evidence changes it, you write the next version rather than editing the last one, because the sequence of changes is itself part of your research record.

The four rails, here

Four concerns cross every studio in this book. At this milestone they take these specific forms.

- **Ethics, permissions, and data exposure.** An adaptation that drops the limitations is not a shorter version, it is a different claim.
- **Evidence, provenance, and reproducibility.** Every figure that travels carries its verification with it.
- **AI activity, verification, and human decisions.** If AI edits the artifact or generates questions, record what changed and verify the result; every defend-or-concede decision remains yours.
- **Uncertainty, claim boundary, and revision history.** The shorter the format, the more explicit the boundary has to be.

Where this milestone sits

You arrived carrying Milestone 9: Your bounded claims. Milestone 11 lets strangers rerun what you have just defended, which is the one test rehearsal cannot give you. The chain ends at Milestone 12: Your release and next cycle, where you decide whether your finished research artifact leaves your hands.

What sends you back

A question you cannot answer in rehearsal is evidence, and it sends you back to the studio that owns it.

How this milestone is assessed

Each row scores **0, 1, or 2. 10 points total.**

#	Criterion	0	1	2
1	The milestone artifact exists in full, specific to your own project	absent, or generic text that would fit any project	present but incomplete, or specific in some parts and generic in others	complete and unmistakably about your project
2	The milestone is written as a dated, numbered version with its reason	no version, or a version with no reason given	versioned, but the reason is decorative rather than an account of what changed	versioned with a reason a reader could use to reconstruct your thinking
3	Every judgment in the artifact is defended by you, not asserted by a tool	conclusions appear with no reasoning, or reproduce a tool's wording	reasoning present but thin where the decision was hardest	each judgment carries a reason you could defend under questioning
4	The four rails are carried in the form this studio requires	one or more rails absent where this studio required them	all rails present but one is nominal	every rail addressed in the form this studio requires
5	The milestone's own product is present and defensible: A short venue contract and one artifact ready for publication or presentation that satisfies it - a paper or research note, a seminar or conference talk, a poster, or another venue's format - with a content map tracing every load-bearing claim and number, and a defense rehearsal record. This is not yet public release	contract, adaptation, content map, or rehearsal absent, or a load-bearing claim exceeds its evidence	all pieces present, but one load-bearing number, boundary, accessibility path, or mode test is incomplete	the adaptation satisfies its declared contract, every load-bearing claim and number is traceable, uncertainty travels with the claim, and the rehearsal records defensible responses plus the unresolved work

! Blocking gate

No work at or after Studio 4 proceeds past a not-authorized determination. This is not scored and cannot be averaged away.

Your workbook

Open the workbook with the link above. It walks these steps with a cell for each one, ends by writing your milestone version with its reason, and adds the rows this studio contributes to your AI Research Ledger and your Research Dossier.